

Scene 8: The City Restored

TIME

~10 minutes

PURPOSE

Celebration • Reward players • Closing image • Hope restored

THE RESTORATION

'Blade is warm now, glowing softly. It pulses, tugging toward windows. It wants you to see.
You look out over Rjocht. Fog completely gone. Sunlight bathes city in gold. Transformation already beginning.
Gardens - choked with weeds - are blooming. Flowers opening, reaching toward sun. Vines crawl up walls, green and alive.
Market stalls: Potter already at wheel, adding flourishes, curves, beauty - joy returning to craft. Spice merchant opening hidden crates - smell of cinnamon and rosemary.
Music drifts from window - lute, tentative then bolder. Others join with song.
Children running through streets, laughing, playing. Parents watching with tears.
The city isn't just free - it's coming ALIVE again.'

ELDER GREYMANE ARRIVES

'Footsteps behind you. Elder Greymane, leaning on staff, eyes bright with tears.
"I felt it. The moment the curse broke. The moment light returned. The Spirit of Life flowing freely through Rjocht again.
You have done what seemed impossible. Not because you were strongest, but because you were faithful. Because you bore what needed to be borne, and you bore it together.'"

ACKNOWLEDGMENT (Customize based on actual gameplay)

Elder Greymane recognizes specific choices:

- If kind to Jasper: 'You showed kindness to stranger, were rewarded with wisdom. Mercy and compassion are not weakness.'
 - If helped guards: 'You saw that even those who serve oppression can be victims. You showed them grace.'
 - If freed Constance: 'You chose to free the captive even when it cost you. Faithfulness recognized faithfulness.'
 - If kept promise: 'You kept your word even when breaking it might have been easier. Your word is your bond.'
- To blade-bearer: 'You bore the weight of judgment itself. You carried what others could not. But you did not carry it alone. Your companions were your strength, as you were theirs. Remember: the greatest burdens are never meant to be borne alone.'

THE PEOPLE'S GRATITUDE

People gather at base of keep, looking up. When they see you at window, a cheer erupts. Not just cheering - thanksgiving.
Constance: 'They're calling for you. They want to see the ones who freed them. Will you come down?'

IF PLAYERS GO DOWN:

Crowd parts. People reach out to touch them, thank them, bless them.

- Kael (if met): 'I told you we'd rise up once he fell. Thank you for believing we were worth saving.'
- Tam and Beren (if helped): 'You did it. My sister's children will grow up free now. Thank you.'
- Jasper arrives: 'I KNEW it! Look at this - JOY returning to Rjocht! It always comes back, doesn't it? Always!'

THE REWARDS

Elder Greymane: 'The Order does not give rewards for faithful service - faithfulness itself is the reward. But there are gifts meant for this moment.'

LEGENDARY DISTRIBUTION:

- Blade-bearer can finally receive other items/weapons if desired (burden complete)
- Each player draws 1 Legendary card
- 'These are not earned. They are given freely, because you are loved and chosen.'

THE BLADE: 'The Blade has served its purpose. It will return to the Order, kept safe until next time needed. But it will remember you. The one who carried it. The ones who stood beside them.'

[To blade-bearer] 'Your burden is lifted. Well done, good and faithful servant.'

THE CLOSING IMAGE

Evening falls. City transformed. Streets full of people talking, laughing, embracing. Market stalls open late, giving away food in celebration. Music from every corner.

You sit together in city square. Great feast being prepared. Tables set up, food appearing from hidden stores - better days have come.

Constance raises cup: 'To the Order! To the bearers of light! To freedom!' Crowd roars.

You sit around fire, your company. Blade rests nearby - no longer cold, but warm, content. Weapons and tools laid aside.

Abilities, tested in battle, now rest.

Tomorrow, work to do. City must be rebuilt. Corrupted must be healed or driven out. Life must be rebuilt.

But tonight... tonight there is peace.

Stars shine overhead, brighter than ever. Spirit of Life flows through Rjocht like river returning to bed.

And you rest, knowing you have done well.

ELDER GREYMANE'S FINAL WORDS

'Sleep well, young ones. You've earned it. And when you wake... well, there are other cities. Other servants of Drachan. Other battles to fight.

But that is for tomorrow. Tonight, we celebrate.'

THE VERY END

'The fire crackles. Your companions' faces glow in warm light. Laughter rings across square. Children play. Adults dance. Rjocht is free.

And somewhere, far away, in deepest darkness, Drachan the Accuser feels it - one of his generals has fallen. One of his strongholds has been reclaimed. And he knows:

The Third Age has truly begun. The children of light are rising.

But that... is a story for another day.

For now: rest. You've won.

THE END'

POST-GAME (Optional)

Debrief with players:

- 'What was your favorite moment?'
- 'What did you learn about your character?'
- 'Would you want to play again?'
- Acknowledge specific awesome moments
- Praise creative solutions and teamwork

- Thank them for playing!